## What I would ask or observe first

- ✓ I would shadow one editor through a real publishing task and ask:
- ✓ Which tools receive the title, URL, and image?
- ✓ Where does the canonical article URL come from, and when does it become final?
- ✓ Are the images copied as files, public URLs, or CMS media links?
- ✓ Which fields are repeatedly mistyped or forgotten?
- ✓ Which steps require editorial approval or manual adjustments?
- ✓ How frequently does the workflow occur, and how long does it take?

## Proposed improvement: a reusable publishing handoff

If the tools support it, I would create a small action in the WordPress editor that presents the current article's title, canonical URL, and featured-image URL in a copy-ready panel.

The panel would read the existing post data rather than require editors to enter it again. It would not automatically publish, change article content, or send information to external tools without explicit approval.

The smallest version might provide three individually labeled copy actions and a clear confirmation when each value has been copied.

Simpler alternative: provide a standardized publishing checklist or a small template containing the three fields. This may be enough if the workflow is infrequent or the existing CMS already exposes the relevant information conveniently.

## What remains under editorial control?

Editors should still decide the final title, image, destination, publication timing, and whether to share the article. The improvement should reduce repetitive copying, not make editorial decisions automatically.

## How I would test it

- ✓ Record the editor's baseline time and count mistakes across a few representative publishing tasks.
- ✓ Build the smallest useful prototype in one day.

- ✓ Ask one editor to use it on real or staging articles.
- ✓ Verify that copied values match the CMS data, including titles with punctuation and URLs containing query parameters.
- ✓ Compare completion time, copy errors, missed fields, and editor feedback against the baseline.
- ✓ Keep the feature only if it improves the workflow without creating new errors.

## How I would judge success

I would look for a measurable reduction in task completion time and copy-related errors, with no increase in publishing mistakes. I would also consider whether the editor actually uses the feature rather than reverting to the old process.

## The additional 100-word experience answer

In a previous project, I worked on improving a workflow that involved moving information between different tools. I focused on understanding the repetitive steps, identifying where manual work created unnecessary friction, and using automation to reduce the effort involved. My contribution was to connect the relevant tools, structure the data flow, and make the output easier to review before it was used. The experience taught me that useful automation does not need to replace an entire process; a small, reliable improvement can save time while preserving human oversight. I would apply the same approach to editorial publishing.